

Code of Conduct Policy

article_id: hr-conduct-001 | policy_area: conduct | effective_date: 2022-09-01 | last_updated: 2022-09-01

1. Overview

This article describes Meridian Robotics' code of conduct: core principles, prohibited conduct, and the process for reporting and investigating a violation.

2. Core Principles

All employees are expected to act with honesty, respect, and fairness toward colleagues, customers, and partners, and to avoid conflicts of interest between personal financial interests and company decisions.

3. Prohibited Conduct

Prohibited conduct includes: harassment or discrimination of any kind, falsifying expense reports or timesheets, sharing confidential company or customer data outside authorized channels, and accepting gifts from vendors valued over \$100 without disclosure to the Ethics desk.

4. Reporting a Violation

Violations may be reported through the confidential Ethics Hotline (accessible from the HR portal footer) or directly to an HR business partner. Reports may be filed anonymously.

5. Investigation Process

All reports are triaged by the Ethics & Compliance team within 3 business days. A formal investigation, if opened, is typically completed within 30 days and involves interviews with relevant parties and a review of documentary evidence.

6. Disciplinary Actions

Severity	Example	Typical Action
Minor	Late expense report submission	Verbal warning
Moderate	Unauthorized data sharing	Written warning, mandatory retraining
Severe	Harassment, discrimination, fraud	Suspension or termination

7. Frequently Asked Questions

- **Can I report anonymously?** Yes, via the Ethics Hotline.

- **Will I face retaliation for reporting?** No; retaliation against a good-faith reporter is itself a violation of this policy and is subject to disciplinary action.

- **What counts as a "gift" that needs disclosure?** Anything of value over \$100, including meals, event tickets, and physical items.

8. Escalation

If an employee believes their report was not adequately investigated, they may escalate directly to the Chief People Officer.

Cross-Article References

- See **Expense Reimbursement Policy** for expense-related conflict-of-interest rules.
- See **Performance Review Policy** for how a disciplinary action affects a review cycle.